

ETHIOPIAN COMMUNITY SAN FRANCISCO (ECSF)



Bylaws (2026)

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Mission Statement

The Ethiopian Community San Francisco (ECSF) is an inclusive, non-political, and non-religious civic organization established to support Ethiopians and Ethiopian Americans living in San Francisco and the surrounding Bay Area.

Introduction

We, Ethiopians and Ethiopian Americans living in San Francisco and the surrounding Bay Area, have willingly formed this organization to address problems arising within our community, to preserve our great cultural assets, to enhance gainful adaptations to the culture, laws and traditions of our new habitation, to create a strong community without any preference based on ethnicity, political opinion or religious beliefs, and to facilitate closeness and understanding so as to realize better services for our community. To fulfill this vision, we have set up an all-inclusive organization and hereby create this Bylaw and resolve its passage on this day of May 25, 2026.

Chapter 1 – Establishment

Section 1. Name:

Ethiopian Community San Francisco (ECSF)

Section 2. Jurisdiction of Bylaws:

This Bylaw applies to members who live in San Francisco and the surrounding cities.

Section 3. Working Languages:

The working languages of E.C.S.F. are Amharic and English.

Section 4. Address:

The headquarters of the E.C.S.F will be in the City of San Francisco.

Section 5. Translation: In this Bylaw:

- 5.1** Ethiopian American: An American born of Ethiopian descent or married to an Ethiopian legally residing in the region, and a member of E.C.S.F.
 - 5.2** San Francisco and the Surrounding Area: San Francisco and the surrounding area means members of E.C.S.F. living in counties located in San Francisco and the Bay Area counties.
 - 5.3** Member: Member means individuals that have fulfilled the obligations of membership requirements and include those who are elected to hold office and perform duties of the E.C.S.F.
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5.4 Family: Family means the member's husband or wife, children, and the parents living with them.

5.5 Organization: Organization refers to the E.C.S.F.

5.6 E.C.S.F.: E.C.S.F. means the Ethiopian Community in San Francisco

5.7 General Assembly:

The General Assembly is a gathering of members in good standing of ECSF. The General Assembly serves as an advisory and consultative body that provides recommendations, community feedback, and guidance to the Board of Directors. Final governance authority remains with the Board of Directors.

5.8 Board Of Directors:

The Board of Directors is the highest governing and decision-making body of ECSF. The Board has full authority over the affairs, finances, policies, strategic direction, appointments, and administration of the organization in accordance with these bylaws and applicable laws.

5.9 Executive Committee: Executive committee means members elected or assigned by the Board who execute the day-to-day work of the E.C.S.F.

5.10 Executive Director: Executive Director means a person elected or hired by the Board and is the authority for directing the work of the executive committee and represents the E.C.S.F

Section 6. Name, Seal, and Logo

6.1 As stated in Section 1 Using the name of the organization, the bylaws and the seal or adding and subtracting words in the bylaw is prohibited by law.

Chapter 2 – Objectives

Section 7. E.C.S. F's Objectives

E.C.S.F. has the following objectives:

- 7.1.** Enhance closeness among Ethiopians and Ethiopian Americans and enable them to continuously develop their culture and enrich their history by creating a communal forum.
- 7.2** Create organizational strength without any preference based on ethnicity, political opinion, religious belief, age, etc. by all Ethiopian immigrants and Ethiopian Americans who have accepted the by-laws and are working together to establish a strong community that defends our shared rights.
- 7.3** Devise ways and means to enable the sick, those with disabilities, those affected by death and accidents, the unemployed, and the new Ethiopian arrivals to efficiently transition into life in their new environment.
- 7.4** Provide support to our community members in healthy living through education, training, physical education, recreation etc., and creating a community center.
- 7.5** Provide counseling and training to the youth of our community to avoid destructive behaviors, criminal activities, and drug addictions; provide aid in rehabilitation.
- 7.6** Prepare and provide a venue(s) where the elderly can relax and spend their day.
- 7.7** Provide defense by communally standing together when human rights abuse and lack of justice unfolding impacting members of our community
- 7.8** Engage physicians and other medical professionals to educate our communities about topics like cancer, mental health, and autism. Provide help and support to the youth in securing opportunities for free education and social service(s). Prepare educational panels to educate our youth on prevention and cure for different diseases.

Chapter 3 – ECSF's Source of Funds

Section 8. E.C.S.F's Source of program funds:

- 8.1** Funds from annual membership fees.
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- 8.2** From the preparation of different fundraising events.
- 8.3** Funds from government and foundation grants to fund E.C.S.F.'s project proposals.
- 8.4** Financial support from the goodwill of individuals and members of the E.C.S.F

Section 9: Membership Contributions/Dues

- 9.1** Individuals who accept the by-laws of E.C.S.F. and register to be members of the organization will pay an annual fee of \$50 per person for general membership. Members can opt to make annual recurring payments or may choose to make multiyear payments for up to three years.
- 9.2** Retired members get a 50% discount making their membership fees \$25.

Chapter 4 – Organizational Structure, Powers, and Duties

Section 10. General Assembly:

The General Assembly is a meeting of members in good standing who support the goals and objectives of ECSF.

- 10.1** Serves as an advisory body to the Board of Directors.
 - 10.2** Provides recommendations, concerns, and community feedback to the Board.
 - 10.3** Meets at least once annually to receive reports regarding the activities, finances, and programs of ECSF.
 - 10.4** May submit recommendations regarding bylaws, programs, budgets, and organizational priorities for Board consideration.
 - 10.5** May be called into regular or special meetings by the Board Chairperson.
 - 10.6** Does not possess final decision-making authority over the organization.
 - 10.7** Board decisions shall not require approval of the General Assembly except where specifically required by law.
 - 10.8** The Board may consult the General Assembly before major organizational initiatives when deemed appropriate.
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10.9 A General Assembly meeting may proceed with members present for informational and advisory purposes and does not constitute a governing quorum for organizational decision making.

Section 11 : The Advisory Board

The Advisory Board shall consist of up to five (5) members appointed by the Board of Directors. The Advisory Board serves in an advisory capacity and provides recommendations to the Board of Directors on community development, governance, education, culture, legal matters, strategic planning, and conflict resolution. The Advisory Board is accountable to the Board of Directors.

The Advisory Board shall not exercise governing authority over ECSF and shall not override decisions of the Board of Directors. Final authority on all organizational matters remains with the Board of Directors.

The Advisory Board shall have the following duties and responsibilities:

- 11.1** The Board of Directors may request recommendations and advice from the Advisory Board regarding the growth, development, and sustainability of ECSF.
 - 11.2** The Advisory Board shall provide guidance on social, cultural, educational, community, and legal matters affecting ECSF.
 - 11.3** The Advisory Board may assist in resolving conflicts, disputes, or governance concerns among Board members, committees, officers, volunteers, or members and shall encourage cooperation and unity within the organization.
 - 11.4** Prior to referring major disputes to external legal processes, the Advisory Board shall review the matter and attempt mediation. If the matter remains unresolved, the Advisory Board shall submit written recommendations to the Board of Directors for final review and determination.
 - 11.5** Advisory Board members shall serve two-year terms and may be reappointed by the Board of Directors.
 - 11.6** Vacancies on the Advisory Board shall be filled by appointment of the Board of Directors.
 - 11.7** Advisory Board members may attend meetings of the Board of Directors in an advisory capacity when invited but shall not possess voting authority on Board matters.
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Section 12 : The Board Of Directors

The Board of Directors is the highest governing and decision-making authority of ECSF. The Board shall oversee all organizational affairs, finances, policies, strategic planning, appointments, compliance, and governance matters.

The Board shall consist of seven (7) to eleven (11) directors. Board vacancies and future Board appointments shall be filled by majority vote of the existing Board of Directors.

The Board shall seek community input through the General Assembly and may consider recommendations submitted by members; however, final decision-making authority remains with the Board of Directors.

The board duties and responsibilities:

- 12.1** Ensures that activities taken by the executive committee follow the bylaws.
 - 12.2** Makes certain that the properties and finances of the E.C.S.F. are handled and monitored appropriately.
 - 12.3** When its term ends, the exiting Board will collaborate and participate as needed for up to six (6) months with newly appointed Board members to ensure continuity of operations, governance, and organizational knowledge.
 - 12.4** Makes sure the external communications by the executive committee don't contradict the goals of the E.C.S.F.
 - 12.5** Reviews, examines, and approves long and short-term project proposals submitted by the executive committee.
 - 12.6** Meets every three (3) months to hear the report of the executive committee activities; directs corrections and improvements to be made to the report, devises methods to strengthen the organization and follows up and studies ways to empower conscious participation of members.
 - 12.7** Board resolutions will pass when one side gets a vote of more than 50%.
 - 12.8** Approves hiring and compensation for temporary and permanent employees when the executive committee makes a recommendation, at a time when the organization has enough funds.
 - 12.9** Prepares internal rules and regulations to govern itself in ways that do not contradict the Bylaws of the E.C.S.F.
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- 12.10** Approves expenses that are greater than \$3,000.00.
- 12.11** The board has the power to convene and disband committees as needed.
- 12.12** Besides the 5 officers the remaining 6 board members will also have additional responsibilities beyond regular board duties and will be assigned to board committees.
- 12.13** When its term ends, the exiting board will collaborate/participate as needed for six (6) months with the new board to enable continuity.
- 12.14** The Board of Directors shall have the authority to appoint, reappoint, replace, or fill vacancies on the Board of Directors by majority vote. In exercising this authority, the Board shall consider recommendations and community input received through the General Assembly and other community engagement activities.

Section 13. The Board Chairperson:

The Board chairperson is elected by the general assembly and is accountable to the Board and the general assembly and the duties and responsibilities are:

- 13.1** Chairs and leads board meetings.
 - 13.2** Calls and chairs meetings of the Board of Directors and may call regular or special meetings of the General Assembly for advisory, informational, or community consultation purposes.
 - 13.3** Ensures the board and the executive committee members perform their duties according to the bylaws.
 - 13.4** Encourages the board, the executive committee members, and the director to perform their duties/responsibilities with competency and determination.
 - 13.5** Together with the executive committee and director assign members to different committees by following the internal governance regulations and implementing assignments after getting board approval.
 - 13.6** Signs checks and signs instruction to pay for expenditures.
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Section 14 The Vice-Chairperson of the Board:

The Vice Chairperson of the Board is elected by the general assembly and is accountable to the Board and the general assembly and the duties and responsibilities are:

- 14.1** Acts and functions as the chairperson in the absence of the board chairperson on functions and duties that are like the chairpersons.
- 14.2** Performs the administrative and monitoring functions given by the board chairperson.

Section 15 The Board Secretary:

The Board secretary is elected by the general assembly and is accountable to the Board and the general assembly and the duties and responsibilities are:

- 15.1** Communicates calls for regular and emergency meetings following the directive of the board chairperson.
- 15.2** Keeps minutes of the board and the general assembly meetings.
- 15.3** Reads and gets approval of past meetings at every meeting of the board and ensures approval of past meeting minutes.
- 15.4** Performs the duties of the board secretary, and holds all records, documents, and reports.
- 15.5** Keeps records of every member of the E.C.S.F.
- 15.6** Prepares inbound and outbound letters and when signed by the chairperson sends them to the intended parties.
- 15.7** Signs checks
- 15.8** Performs all duties assigned by the board chairperson.

Section 16. The Public Relations Officer:

The Public Relations Officer is elected by the general assembly and is accountable to the Board and the general assembly and disseminates information on the ECSF activities through media, flyers, radio, and internet.

The duties and responsibilities are:

- 16.1** Prepares video recordings of the general assembly, the board and executive committee meetings and files them.
- 16.2** Prepares videos of the main work of committees for dissemination to the community.
- 16.3** Interviews with responsible parties/individuals on current and timely topics/ information to distribute to members.
- 16.4** Coordinates with members to implement necessary functions and follows up on progress of work and completion.
- 16.5** Follows up on private and government organizations and as necessary provides information after approval by the board.
- 16.6** Board members must get approval by the board prior to communicating on ECSF matters to the media.
- 16.7** Ensures approval of the board or director prior to dissemination of digital materials, print materials, and video recordings.

Section 17.0 The Treasurer:

The treasurer is elected by the general assembly and is accountable to the Board and the general assembly and the duties and responsibilities are:

- 17.1** The treasurer dutifully manages the revenues and expenses of the E.C.S, F. Prepares monthly, quarterly, and annual financial reports.
 - 17.2** Monitors that members have paid their annual dues.
 - 17.3** Ensures the director or the board chairperson or vice-chairperson has approved and signed the instruction to pay form prior to expenses (invoices) being paid.
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- 17.4** Ensures the director, the board chairperson, and vice-chairperson all have approved and signed the check or at least two officers have signed prior to expenses (invoices) being paid.
- 17.5** Ensures that revenues or money coming to the organization is recorded and receipt(s) that have numerical sequence and emblem of the organization are provided to the sender.
- 17.6** Ensures that all revenue (money) received by the organization is deposited within twenty-four (24) hours in the E.C.S.F. account.

Section 18. The Audit (Control) Committee:

The Audit Committee is a three (3) member committee appointed by the Board of Directors and accountable to the Board.

- 18.1** Prepares and distributes charter for the handling of finances, accounts, and ECSF property for the board's approval. Once approved it allots the work to the responsible parties.
 - 18.2** Provides reports every six (6) months or as necessary to ensure that the executive expenditure (finance and accounts) follow the bylaws
 - 18.3** Prepares a detailed report to the board, the executive committee, and the general assembly once a year.
 - 18.4** Conducts audits into accounts and completes work as necessary and notifies the board or the general assembly.
 - 18.5** Prepares a report that will be signed by both the incoming (new) and departing officials two months prior to the end of the board and the executive committees' terms of service.
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- 18.6** Ensures that all financial policies and procedures of E.C.S.F. are followed in all the departments accordingly, and within budget and time set for planned projects.

Section 19 The Executive Committee:

The Executive Committee is elected by the board and performs the day-to-day work of the E.C.S.F. and is answerable to the board. All the board officers will serve on the executive committee, and this committee will be chaired by the executive director.

The duties and responsibilities are:

- 19.1** Retains the registration list of all members and enrolls members of the organization.
- 19.2** Conducts the day-to- day activities of the organization.
- 19.3** The Executive Committee shall be accountable to the Board of Directors, and all major decisions of the Executive Committee remain subject to Board oversight.
- 19.4** Drafts plans to strengthen the E.C.S.F. and implements it after approval by the board.
- 19.5** Ensures members of the organization are provided with services according to the bylaws, and monitors members are meeting their responsibilities.
- 19.6** Prepares the organization's yearly budget and work plans and presents it to the board for approval and implementation.
- 19.7** Ensures all work plans and projects follow the timelines and budgets according to the ECSF policies and procedures.
- 19.8** Convenes temporary committees as needed to complete urgent tasks in a timely manner with board approval
- 19.9** Ensures keeping finance and property records of the organization securely.
- 19.10** Reviews the activities of committees and gives directives at the executive committee meetings conducted at least once a month.
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19.11 The administrative assistant and director are responsible for coordinating the executive committee meetings and will invite other committee members involved in the matter as necessary.

19.12 Presents expenses that exceed \$3000.00 to the board for approval: implements expenditure after approval by the board.

19.13 The director calls and leads the executive committee meeting and half (1/2) of the committee members need to be present to meet the minimum requirement (quorum).

Section 20. The Executive Director:

The Executive Director shall be appointed, hired, evaluated, and removed by the Board of Directors and shall be accountable to the Board of Directors.

20.1 Administers and leads the activities of the executive committee. Prepares reports every three months on its activities and presents them to the board.

20.2 Chairs the executive committee meetings, participates in board meetings, and is a nonvoting member of the board.

20.3 Represents the E.C.S.F. in public relations and negotiates on behalf of the E.C.S.F. Devises ways and means to raise funds and materials to meet the financial needs and implementation of goals of the E.C.S.F. and executes them when approved by the board.

20.4 Makes sure members of the executive committee perform their duties and fulfill their responsibilities according to the bylaws.

20.5 Ensures work plans and projects are completed on a timely schedule.

20.6 Encourages committee members to consult with each other and work with understanding and harmony.

20.7 Makes sure the finance and property of the E.C.S.F. is handled properly and when mismanagement of work and waste is noticed, takes corrective action(s).

20.8 Sends operating expense instruction letters to the finance committee; signs on the bank check(s).

- 20.9** Prepares internal directive (s) on steps to discipline committee members.
- 20.10** A majority (50%) of committee members must reach agreement and get board approval before implementing any directives.
- 20.11** The director will hire a bookkeeper or accountant to assist with the organization's finances. Hire temporary and permanent employees and supervise them as approved by the board.
- 20.12** Will perform other board assigned duties.
- 20.13** Annually prepares a magazine for distribution to members.

Section 21: The Administrative Office Assistant

The Administrative Office Assistant shall be appointed or hired by the Board of Directors or Executive Director subject to Board policy. The Administrative Office Assistant's Duties and Responsibilities are:

- 21.1** Coordinates the work of the executive committee.
 - 21.2** Receives incoming and outgoing letters and distributes them to the concerned bodies, files them in an orderly and sequential manner.
 - 21.3** Retains and safeguards records of members.
 - 21.4** Will call meetings of the executive committee when the director calls it, takes minutes of the executive meetings, and files the meeting documents chronologically.
 - 21.5** Will plan the schedule of the E.C.S.F.'s office hours and when approved by the committee will implement and confirm their execution. Will identify the material needs of the office in detail and request a budget for it.
 - 21.6** Will follow up and report to the director that the planned projects are performed within budget and in the time allocated
 - 21.7** Will perform other duties as assigned by the director.
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CHAPTER 5: Membership

Section 22 Membership Requirements:

To become a member of the E.C.S.F. the following requirements must be met:

- 22.1** Must be Ethiopian, Ethiopian American or married to an Ethiopian.
- 22.2** Must understand the bylaws of the E.C.S.F. and have completed the registration form.
- 22.3** Must be 18 years of age or over.

Section 23. Membership Rights:

- 23.1** Based on the bylaws, all members have the right to get equal service from ECSF.
- 23.2** Has the right to participate in meetings with freedom of expression.
- 23.3** Has the right to participate in community meetings, serve on committees, submit recommendations to the Board of Directors, and be considered for appointment to leadership positions in accordance with these bylaws and Board policies.
- 23.4** Has the right to become a member if the individual cannot pay membership dues because of sickness, accident, unemployment etc.
- 23.5** Membership in ECSF does not automatically grant voting rights in governance matters. Governance authority is vested in the Board of Directors as provided in these bylaws.

Section 24. Membership Responsibilities

- 24.1** A member must attend meetings.
 - 24.2** Respect the Bylaws of the E.C.S.F.
 - 24.3** Pay annual dues following the bylaw requirement(s).
 - 24.4** Properly use the E.C.S.F. services and property.
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- 24.5** Provide unpaid community services in committee(s).

Section 25. Expulsion from the Organization

- 25.1** A member will be expelled from ECSF if he/she fails to meet member duties three consecutive times without justifications (see member duties in section 24 above)
- 25.2** A member will receive a notice to improve the deficiency in a letter from the executive committee with time limit twice. If the member fails to meet the notice requirements in the time allocated, he/she will receive a letter of dismissal from the E.C.S.F.
- 25.3** Once a member is expelled, none of the fees paid to the organization by the member will be refunded.
- 25.4** Once a member is expelled and applies for membership for the second time, a \$30.00 penalty fee will be charged and a second and final chance will be given to him/her for membership.
- 25.5** Members shall not use ECSF activities, resources, or communication channels to promote personal political agendas, partisan activities, or divisive conduct that conflicts with the mission and unity of ECSF.
- 25.6** The E.C.S.F. is not obligated to provide services to individuals not registered as members or who have the means but fail to meet their membership requirements

Section 26. Expulsion from the Board

- 26.1** If a board member is absent three (3) consecutive times from board meetings or does not participate/ is absent half of the time each year and has no adequate justification, the position will be filled by another member.
- 26.2** Any board member that failed to meet his/her duties and responsibilities.
- 26.3** If the board member's action exposed the safety and well-being of the organization, the Board of Directors may remove the board member by a three-fourths ($\frac{3}{4}$) vote of the sitting Board after providing notice and an opportunity to be heard.
- 26.4** The decision of the board to the expelled/removed board member will be sent in a registered mail to his/her address within 10 days.
- 26.5** A board member has the right to attend the board expulsion hearing and express his/her thoughts.
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Section 27. A board member who wishes to resign:

- 27.1** The board member will present a letter of resignation to the board president: if it is the board president that is resigning, he/she will present the resignation letter to the board secretary, and the matter will be addressed at the next board meeting.
- 27.2** The remaining Board members may appoint a replacement director to fill the vacancy.
- 27.3.** If multiple vacancies significantly impair Board operations, the Board may appoint interim directors and seek community recommendations before making permanent appointments.

Section 28:-Board Indemnity Waiver:

- 28.1** The board and the executive officers and all employees and volunteers who serve ECSF have individual responsibility for all the problems that arise in the performance of their work but will not result in a lawsuit/legal action. However, if negligence and deliberate dereliction to duty and abuse of authority is established, he/she will be responsible for the mistake.
- 28.2** ECSF will provide liability insurance to the elected board members and director.

Section 29:-Conflict of Interest

To protect the organization's interest and entertain conditions that appear like conflict, the following, when they appear are indicators of conflict of interest:

- 29.1** When a board member or the organization officer(s) or volunteer (s) (or their family members) negotiate/deal for goods and service(s) with the organization.
 - 29.2** When a board member or the organization officer(s) or volunteer (s) (or their family members) make /enable agreements on behalf of ECSF with financial institutions by using, befriending, representing, standing-in, by special and notable relationship in the organization they serve.
 - 29.3** When a board member or the organization officer(s) or volunteer (s) (or their family members) bid against ECSF with financial organizations they have interest in.
 - 29.4** When a board member or the organization officer(s) or volunteers (or their family
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members) receive gifts, invitations, to influence outcome (gifts and invitations that are not related to ECSF are excluded).

29.5 Other activities of ECSF on financial matters that create conflict of interest.

29.6 A board member or the organization officer(s) or volunteers needs to notify the board if conflict of interest unfolds/arises (including time conflict) to protect the organization's interest.

29.7 The board will prepare an internal directive on matters of conflict of interest.

Section 30:-Confidentiality Clause:

Board officers, employees and volunteers who serve the organization must avoid sharing information that should be kept confidentially or conflicts with the interest of ECSF. Board officers, employees and volunteers who serve the organization must not use information acquired from ECSF for his/her private or family use and gain.

Chapter 6 Miscellaneous Provisions

Section 31. Election and Voting Procedures:

Prior to any elections, it is important to ensure that membership requirements of candidates have been fulfilled and that the candidates are fit to elect and be elected.

31.1 Members may participate in advisory surveys, consultations, community forums, and recommendation processes established by the Board of Directors. Any Board appointment or reappointment process shall be conducted according to Board policies.

31.2 The Board shall establish procedures for Board appointments, leadership succession, and community consultation consistent with these bylaws.

Section 32 Governance and Nominating Committee:

The Board may establish a Governance and Nominating Committee to identify qualified candidates for Board service and leadership positions.

- 32.1** The Governance and Nominating Committee shall receive recommendations and nominations from Board members, community members, committees, and stakeholders for leadership positions within ECSF.
- 32.2** The Committee shall review the qualifications, willingness, experience, integrity, commitment, and competencies of prospective candidates and provide recommendations to the Board of Directors.
- 32.3** Prospective candidates may be requested to submit resumes, biographies, statements of interest, or other supporting information demonstrating their qualifications and commitment to the mission of ECSF.
- 32.4** The Committee may use meetings, interviews, community outreach, and other appropriate methods to evaluate candidates and encourage leadership development within ECSF.
- 32.5** The Committee shall submit qualified candidates and recommendations to the Board of Directors for consideration and appointment.
- 32.6** The Committee shall maintain transparency and fairness throughout the nomination and recommendation process and shall report its activities to the Board.
- 32.7** The Board of Directors may appoint, replace, or dissolve the Governance and Nominating Committee as necessary.

Section 33 Board Member appointment and composition

- 33.1** Husbands and wives, fathers and mothers, brothers and sisters shall not serve on the Board of Directors simultaneously.
 - 33.2** The Board of Directors shall consist of seven (7) to eleven (11) members. Advisory Board members and Audit and Control Committee members shall be appointed by the Board of Directors as provided in these bylaws.
 - 33.3** Vacancies on the Board shall be filled by majority vote of the Board of Directors.
 - 33.4** In making appointments, the Board shall consider qualifications, experience, commitment to ECSF, diversity of representation, and recommendations received from the community.
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Section 34. The Duration of Service

- 34.1** The term of office for Board members, Advisory Board members, and Audit and Control Committee members shall be two (2) years. Individuals may be reappointed for additional terms. No individual may serve more than two (2) consecutive terms in the same position unless approved by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Board of Directors.

Section 35: Conditions when this bylaw can be changed or improved.

- 35.1** These bylaws may be amended, revised, or improved as necessary to support the mission, growth, and governance of ECSF.
- 35.2** Amendments to these bylaws may be proposed by the Board of Directors and shall require approval by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Board of Directors at a duly called Board meeting. The Board may seek community input through the General Assembly before adopting significant amendments.

Section 36 E.C.S.F. Dissolution:

To dissolve or shut down the E.C.S.F. the following conditions must be met:

- 36.1** ECSF may be dissolved only upon approval by a three-fourths (3/4) vote of the Board of Directors after all legal requirements have been satisfied.
- 36.2** Upon dissolution, all verified debts and legal obligations of ECSF shall be paid in full. Any remaining assets, funds, and property shall be distributed to one or more nonprofit, charitable, educational, or community organizations with purposes similar to ECSF and operating within California, in accordance with applicable law. Section

37: Budget Year

- 37.1** The budget year is from January 1 through December 31

Section 38:-Effective date of this amended bylaw

- 38.1** This bylaw is effective starting June 2026.

Section 39. Translation:

- 39.1** The English and Amharic versions of this bylaw have equal weight.
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